



Family Handbook
2025-2026

Welcome families,

It is a joy to welcome you into our program! Please take some time to read through this handbook so you will understand our expectations for our time together. You can always access the handbook from our website (under the 'resources' tab) or in hard copy form in the policy notebook. The policy notebook also has more detailed information about certain topics, you are welcome to look through it and request copies of your own. As always, if you have any questions or concerns, please let us know. We would love to talk with you more about our policies and procedures and can schedule a meeting or phone call to open up a discussion.

Warmly,
Jeannie and Susan

Table of Contents

Mission	3
Inclusion and Anti-Bias Policy	3
Hours, Calendar, and Closures	4
Preschool Daily Schedule	6
Sprouts Daily Schedule	7
Wild Pear Campus	8
Family Expectations for Arrival and Departure	9
FIVE Things to Bring From Home	11
Outdoor Policy and Gear Info	13
Tuition and Fees	15
WP Trading Days	16
Waitlist	17
Health Policy and Flow Chart	18
Illness and Injury Policy	19
Medication Policy	20
Toileting/Diapering Policy	21
Rest Time Policy	23
Meal Information	24
Rules and Discipline Approach	25
Family Communication	27
Family Involvement	28
Birthdays at Wild Pear Preschool	29
Plan for Meeting Potential Emergencies	29
Certificates and Affiliations	31
Mandated Reporting	32
Report complaint	32

Mission

At Wild Pear, our goal is to meet children where they are at developmentally and encourage them to move forward in their own unique way. With an emphasis on social and emotional health and grounded in a foundation of connected relationships, we engage in activities that invite children to practice a wide range of skill building. Providing time away from a busy fast-paced life, we offer space and time for holistic multifaceted education inspired by direct experiences with food, gardens, and nature.

Inclusion and Anti-Bias Policy

Wild Pear Preschool is an inclusive and welcoming school, meaning your family will be accepted and valued here. We will see and honor you and your child's race, religion, gender, ability, orientation, class, country of origin, immigration status, language, and education level. We respect all family structures; whether you are connected by blood, or law, or love alone, you are welcome here. We believe that diversity in our community gives us an invaluable opportunity to widen our perspectives and enrich our experiences. We also recognize that discomfort/confusion sometimes accompany newness, and there may be a learning curve when it comes to various presentations of diversity. We are glad to help point you towards some wonderful resources to help support your personal learning. Equally, we invite you to share resources with us that can better educate us to the beautiful breadth of experiences in your family. In order to help maintain an atmosphere of respect and safety we always ask for communication that honors the identities of the people in our community.

We actively teach anti-bias curriculum at WPP and like all aspects of your child's education you have a right and responsibility to know how topics are being presented. While we draw from a variety of resources, the work of Louise Derman Sparks, Katie Kissinger, Teaching Tolerance, and Rethinking Schools are a regular inspiration to us. As with all topics at school, anti-bias topics are presented and discussed in an age-appropriate and relevant manner. Some of the core goals and principles of Anti-Bias education can be found on the National Association for the Education of Young Children's website, which you can access with the following link:

[Understanding Anti-Bias Education](#)

Anti-bias work, like most work with young children, is ongoing, ever growing, and requires intentional self-work and introspection on the part of the adults entrusted to teach them. We cannot say it's the easiest part of our work, but we feel it is perhaps one of the most worthwhile. We as individuals are still learning and will undoubtedly make blunders and missteps on our own journeys, but we are committed to keep walking forward towards justice and equity. If you ever feel that a part of your or your child's identity is being disrespected, ignored, or uncelebrated, please bring it to our attention and we will find a way to correct it.

We don't need to know all the personal beliefs, values, and practices of the families in our program, but we do ask that parents support this tender aspect of the work we do at WPP. If you have questions or would like help to find resources to support your own learning, please do

not hesitate to ask. If you find you are unable to walk in this direction with us, it's likely that Wild Pear Preschool is not a good fit for your family and we send you with love as you look for care elsewhere.

Hours & Calendar

We are open Monday through Friday 7:30 am until 5:30 pm. Our school year begins in September and runs until mid-June. We will remain open and offer weekly summer camps for school age children (5-10 years old) during June, July and August. We try hard to offer a handful of summer camp slots to the currently enrolled younger siblings (2-4 years old) of school age children who will be attending camp. More information about this will be sent to eligible families in early Spring.

WP Calendar 2025-2026

August 2025

8/28 Thursday, Open House 3-6pm

September 2025

9/1 Monday, Closed: Labor day

9/2-9/3 Tuesday & Wednesday, Slow Start Days

9/4 Thursday, First day of the 2025-2026 school year

9/9 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

9/26 Friday, Back to school night 4:30-5:45p Walk through and family dinner,
5:45-6:45p Presentation

October 2025

10/13 Monday, Closed: Indigenous Peoples' Day

10/14 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

10/24 Friday, Closed at 2:30: Pumpkin Patch Family Trip 3-5p

November 2025

11/11 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

11/26 Wednesday, Closed: Family Conferences

11/27-11/28 Thursday & Friday Closed: Fall Break

December 2025

12/5 Friday, Parent's night out 5:00-8:00p

12/9 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

12/-22 12/31 Closed for Winter Break

January 2026

1/1-1/2 Closed: for Winter Break

1/13 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

1/19 Monday, Closed: Martin Luther King Jr Day

February 2026

2/10 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

2/16 Monday, Closed: President's Day

2/23-2/24 Monday & Tuesday Closed: Inservice

March 2026

3/10 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

3/23-3/27 Closed for Spring Break

April 2026

4/14 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

4/15 Wednesday, Closed: Family Conferences

May 2026

5/16 Saturday, Spring Fling, Time TBD

5/12 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

5/25 Monday, Closed: Memorial Day

June 2026

6/9 Tuesday, Closed at 3:00: Staff Meeting

6/12 Friday, Last day of the school year

6/12 Friday, Campfire Night 5-7pm

6/22 Monday, School Age Summer Camp begins

July 2025

TBD, Wild Pear Camping Trip

Extreme weather and emergency closures

If both PPS and NCSD are delayed, closing early, or closed all day due to extreme weather, WPP will do the same. If their decisions don't align, we will make our own decision and communicate it as soon as possible.

Winter Weather, Ice and Snow: We love the magic of having the children at school on snowy days where we will gear up and play outside as long as it is safe to do so. If the roads are dangerously icy in the morning, we may have a delayed start and will send an email out early in the morning or perhaps even the night before. If there is a forecast of heavy snow or icy roads in the afternoon we may close early. We love your children but have no desire to be snowed in with them overnight and want to ensure you and our teachers have enough time to pick up and drive home safely. If there is a winter storm that presents a likely risk of power outages or falling trees we will be closed.

Summer Weather, Heat and Smoke: Summer days are glorious here and the combination of lush shade and a breeze off the creek creates a play space cool enough for even the hottest days. During wildfire season our air quality can be dramatically impacted. If the AQ is 150-200 (red) we will be open for a half day only (7:30-12:45), with pick up being directly after lunch. If the AQ is above 200 (purple or maroon) we will be closed. If the school is in a Level 1 evacuation status for wild fires we will remain open but will close immediately if we move to a Level 2 evacuation status. If the evacuation status jumps suddenly to a Level 3 while children are in care we will evacuate with them following our emergency plan detailed in a later heading.

Other unscheduled closures: We can operate in ratio as long as we have at least 2 staff members present for the preschool and 2 staff members for Sprouts, but if too many staff members urgently and unexpectedly need to be out at the same time we may need to close for some or all of the school day. If the school were ever to be without water, electricity, or heat we would need to close immediately. Any flooding, fire, gas leak or other emergency would also result in immediate closure.

We understand and respect that for many families, preschool is more than an enrichment activity and it is often critical child care as well. In the rare case of an unscheduled closure, we will notify you as soon as possible and try our best to remain open if we can do so safely. However, **it is your responsibility to arrange for back up care in the event that we do need to close unexpectedly.**

Preschool Daily Schedule

Our school year schedule is meant to provide children with a reliable rhythm during their time with us. This allows children to know what to expect ahead of time and focus on the learning at hand. We also know that children's needs and focused learning fluctuate so we may choose to modify the schedule as needed.

7:30 Open, Children begin arriving*

8:30 School starts Welcome circle! All children have arrived**

9:00 Breakfast

9:30 Centers/Inside work

10:30/11:00 Outside work

12:30 Upstairs Sleepers start lunch

12:45 Downstairs Sleepers start lunch

1:00 Rest***

3:30 Snack

3:45 Outside work, Children begin leaving

5:30 Closed, All children have left

* If your child needs the focused support of a teacher to transition into their day, please plan to drop them off before 8:15 when the group is smaller and the teachers are not in the process of transitioning everyone inside.

**All children need to be at school, ready to learn by 8:30. Morning circle is a time for us to recognize each child, to share the plan for the day, and to set the tone for the day's work and it's important that your child joins us. You won't be able to drop off after 8:30 unless you have checked in with a director and it's a prearranged circumstance or a true emergency.

***Help us protect the tranquility of rest time by picking up your child before lunch (12:00) or after snack (3:15). If you unexpectedly need to pick up your child during rest time, please contact a director right away.

Sprouts Daily Schedule

The Sprouts Program is meant to nurture and support our youngest community members and much of their scheduling is softer and more individualized than their preschool counterparts. Please do use the preschool schedule as your guide, however. Even at Sprouts we do need all children at school by 8:30, and ask that pick ups be avoided between 12 and 3:15.

All children under 12 months will be on an individual schedule based on the desires of their parents and the child's expressed needs. Bottles and solids will be offered on a schedule and bottles will also be made available on demand. Children will be allowed to sleep when tired.

Children between 12 and 24 months will be gently nudged towards a regular schedule. If a child needs a morning nap we will invite them to sleep wherever the group happens to be and allow them to sleep as long as they need to. Their afternoon nap will happen in a more sleep-inducing environment.

Children over 24 months will consistently be following the following scheduled rhythm:

7:30 Open, Children begin arriving

8:30 School starts- Welcome circle! All children have arrived

9:00 Breakfast

9:30 Centers/Inside work

10:30/11:00 Outside work

12:30 Upstairs Sleepers start lunch

12:45 Downstairs Sleepers start lunch

1:00 Rest

3:30 Snack

3:45 Outside work, Children begin leaving

5:30 Closed, All children have left

Wild Pear Campus

Any time you are here you are welcome to park in our small lot, in the two side by side driveways, or on our side of the street. (The neighbor across the street can get a little fussy about people parking in front of his house and it's important to us to keep a good relationship with him). You can also park in the church parking lot.

We have 3 large fenced play yards on campus:

- The “**Lower Yard**” which is to the right of the blue house (9411), and can be accessed from the gate at the small parking lot, or by walking down and around behind the blue house after entering from the gate on the right at the end of the driveways.

- The “**Sprouts Yard**” which is directly behind white house (9433) and can be accessed through the left gate at the end of the driveways, and

- The “**School Age Yard**” which is behind the sprouts yard has an entrance that is near the teal garage which can be accessed by walking straight back after entering from the gate on the right at the end of the driveways, or by walking up and around after entering from the gate at the parking lot.

Please help us teach children that at school “gates are for grown ups” and make sure all gates are closed securely behind you when you exit a space. The gates do occasionally give us trouble, and if this is the case, please let a teacher or director know so we can attend to it.

Please help us protect the plants and wildlife on the property by staying on the paths (graveled/barkchipped/paved spaces) while walking place to place outside these designated play yards. Because areas outside the play yards are less maintained, we often have insects and plants living there which may not be ideal for children to wander into. There are also 2 sets of outside stairs between the upper and lower yard of the preschool that are not maintained, not licensed, and thus not available for families to use. Instead, please walk on the gravel path or the right of way in front of the house near the street. In order to secure the safety and well being of the children while on site, no children under age 5 are allowed to move around the campus without being directly accompanied by an adult. This includes going between sites, going inside to use the bathroom, or walking to their car. Also, please never leave a child under age 5 in your car, even if you're nearby and just need to snag a sibling real quick. You are welcome to let yourself in the gates and doors as needed anytime your child is scheduled to be there.

We know it's tempting to stick around and play or chat with friends after pick up, however, to remain in accordance with our liability insurance, families need to leave campus after picking up their children and cannot stay and play in unoccupied play yards, in parking lots/driveways, or other parts of campus.

Family Expectations for Arrival and Departure

Arrival

Most days, children will be dropped off outside in their play yard. If you show up and don't see anyone, double check the whiteboard or pop inside to see if there is an inside drop off or a teacher who is on their way out. You are welcome to let yourself in the gates and doors any time your child is scheduled to be in care! Before you leave, make sure your child is set for the weather- sunscreen, rain gear, layers, etc. We cannot send the preschool children up to the covered area alone to grab their jacket or use the bathroom without us, and once you leave it may be a while before a group can head up together. This is also why it's very helpful if you can have your child either use the bathroom right before you leave your house or bring them into the bathroom when you arrive at school.

Please use the app to scan the QR code located on the policy note book on the "parent counter" in the covered area. If for whatever reason the app isn't working, or your child is dropped off by someone without access, let a teacher know so they can sign your child in on that day. The parent counter area will have a lot of information for you, including a whiteboard that will list reminders, low concern health alerts, and information about the learning happening at school. Before you head out, it is your responsibility to make sure a teacher knows you are passing off your child (this can be done simply with eye contact and a wave, or by conversation, greeting, fancy handshake, etc).

If it's likely that your child will need the focused support of a teacher during drop off, we ask that you leave time for the goodbye transition to happen before 8:15. Once the school day starts teachers need to shift their attention to managing breakfast and circle time. **All children need to be at school, ready to learn by 8:30.** Morning circle is a time for us to recognize each child, to share the plan for the day, and to set the tone for the day's work and it's important that your child joins us. Children may not arrive after 8:30 unless a special arrangement has been made in advance, or in the case of an emergency. Please use the app to let us know if you're going to be absent.

To us arriving at school, "ready to learn" means that the child is fully awake, has had time to freshen up and has a clean body and clean fresh clothes on. And a ready to learn child needs to have time to separate from their parent and join the group in a way that feels respectful and unhurried, if not always "happy". Children who are ready to learn are comfortable physically, emotionally, and socially, which allows their brains and bodies to shift into school mode and engage with the work at hand.

If your child is having a difficult time transitioning into their school day- don't worry! We view this as typical behavior and you have many different options:

- Stay for a few minutes and play with your child
- Invite your child to wave to you through/over the fence
- See if your child is interested in holding their family picture while you go
- Ask a teacher to hold your child's body or hand while you leave

We know leaving your child when they are upset can be tricky, especially if you're in a hurry. Rushing through drop off, leaving without saying goodbye, or showing your own discomfort can accidentally give your child the message that you're not sure if they will have a successful day at school. When it's time for you to walk out the gate, we find it's best to give your child a clear message that you are leaving, that you will be back, and that you are confident they will have a good day at school and then leave. Coming back for "just one more hug" or lingering after you have said you're leaving can be very confusing to children and also to teachers who may be trying to assess the need and timing for their support.

Departure

Pick up will most likely happen outside for all children. It is very important for us to make sure children are safe and connected to their grown ups at the end of the day. So similar to drop off, you will need to both sign your child out using the app and make sure a teacher knows you are leaving with your child. Children will only be released to custodial parents and/or legal guardians unless you specify otherwise on their enrollment forms. In order to give families more flexibility during emergencies or unexpected circumstances, we also allow parents to use the app to send the information of a last minute pick up person. Anyone picking up the child who is not recognized by the teacher may be asked to show their ID. Anytime you are having an "out of the norm" pick up person, it helps us so much if you send a message and give us a heads up. If your child is not picked up on time, you will be charged \$1.00 for every minute past 5:30 that they remain in care. That time will be based on the teacher's clock. You will need to pay the fee before your child can attend school the following day.

Children are often tired and ready to head home when they see their parents, other times they might like a few minutes to finish their work or want to share something with you. You are welcome to stay for a while and watch your child play or chat with other adults. Please take time when you first arrive to greet your child and make a plan with them about how long you'll stay, limiting your time to 10 minutes.

We expect young children to be very curious about the consistency of rules and boundaries, it is important work for them to discover who has power and how flexible various limits might be. When you are here with your child, you are their number one grown up, and it is very likely that they will have some strong feelings about being separated from you during the day. At pick up, your child may be eager to reunite with you and lose focus of their prior work. If your child demonstrates behaviors that are increasingly loud, big, and fast, or they seem disengaged, distracted, or begin to clearly test limits and boundaries, we believe it is their way of saying "I'm uncomfortable because I'm unsure about who is in charge right now, I'm ready to shift." It's also not uncommon to see children escalate into conflict with their peers or have outbursts of big

emotions signaling they are ready for you to take the lead and help them transition out of their school day. At this point, we encourage you to respect your child's message and cut your planned visit short, tell your child it's time to leave, and follow through promptly. We understand that this may mean that you need to leave without cleaning up or finishing a conversation. We want your priority to be reconnecting with your child and transitioning to the next phase of the day.

That said, we are also very excited to see you and have time with parents around! We hope to have time to update you on your child's day, share about experience or answer a question. Thank you for remembering that we are still at work actively supervising children, and can only listen with partial attention as we may need to walk away from a conversation to support the children or check in with another parent. This will likely not be a good time for sensitive conversations or administrative type questions, but we can always schedule a time for these types of conversations to happen.

While you are on campus you will likely gain a new perspective of the friendships and play that happen at our school. You are welcome to play with your child or just watch them at their work. If you ever feel that there is a conflict, or other situation with another child that concerns you or might need the support of an adult, we ask that you alert a teacher right away and let us be the one to handle the situation. You are always welcome to step in with your own child, but we do ask parents to refrain from warning, redirecting, scolding, helping, or intervening with other children in our care.

Please do not take photos or videos while you are here, many children have specific photo release plans and are trusting us to protect their child's privacy.

The FIVE Things to Bring From Home

Wet bag, full of **extra clothes**. Blue bag, full of **gear**. Rest bag, full of **bedding**. **Water bottle**.

-Extra clothes. Please bring at least two *full* change of seasonally appropriate clothes, including 4 pairs of socks. These items will live inside the school bathroom in a bin labeled with your child's name, which will be in the bathroom on the floor where they sleep. Their items need to fit comfortably inside the bin. Hair needs to be pulled back and out of your child's face so consider tossing a few extra elastics/clips in their white bin!

-Wet bag. We will provide your child with a wet bag that has two pockets- one for clean clothes and one for soiled clothes. When your child has soiled clothes that need to go home to be washed, they will be in the wet bag, on your child's hook in the covered area. Seeing a wet bag there is your signal to bring it home, wash those close and bring the wet bag back the next day with a clean set of replacement clothes. You will need to put the clean clothes and wet bag into your child's white bin inside the school, please do not leave it on their hooks, or in their blue

bags or nap bags. It's important your child has their wet bag at school each day. If it becomes lost, or your family just needs a few extras, you can purchase more [here](#). We do ask that any "home wet bags" are the same style and labeled the same way as the school bags so your child can have consistency. If your child does not have a wet bag at school, you will get one "reminder plastic bag" and then after that there will be a \$10 fee for each day your child doesn't have a wet bag at school. If your child needs a wet bag frequently, we recommend putting a week's worth in their bin at the start of the week.

-Outdoor gear for the weather. These items live in your child's big blue bag on their hook in the covered area. All gear needs to be able to fit comfortably inside their blue bag. More information on gear can be found later in the handbook, but here is a quick glance:

Fall: Layers, waterproof jacket and rain pants or rain suit, boots

Winter: Warm waterproof coat, warm waterproof boots, hat/hood, gloves/mittens, rain pants/snow pants.

Spring: Layers, waterproof jacket and rain pants or rain suit, boots

Summer: Sandals or sneakers, SPF shirts/hats

Covered area: A warm fleece or hoodie they can wear during meals instead of their rain gear.

-Rest items. At minimum this will include a crib sheet and blanket. You can also send a small pillow and/or ONE stuffy if needed. If your child uses a pacifier please let us know and we will provide a labeled case for it. These items will live inside a provided "nap bag" that we will store in a closet during the week and send home over the weekend for you to wash and return. Any items soiled during the week we will wash on site. Children who occasionally wake up wet will be lent a wet pad which will be sent home weekly for you to wash and send back to school along with their bedding. All of your child's rest items must fit comfortably inside the provided nap bag so we can store them in a sanitary way. At school, it will progressively become your child's responsibility to take out their bedding, set up their cot, remove bedding from their cot and return their rest items to their nap bag. If you notice that YOU have to fold things just right to get it all in there, the odds are your child is going to really struggle with it at school, and you may need to trade out some things.

-Water bottle. This will live in a crate/on a shelf in the covered area. Please make sure your child can open and close their water bottle independently and that the water bottle won't leak if tipped over. Please write your child's name on their water bottle and lid. We will run water bottles through the dishwasher weekly or as needed. They will be sent home during Fall, Winter, Spring and Summer break so you can disassemble and deep clean them at home.

***Please write your child's name or initials on all items. Lost items? Check the lost and found tub.**

Things to leave at home:

- All personal toys, games, books, technology gadgets
- Jewelry, costumes, make up
- Tie shoes, or complicated buckles. Please send them to school in shoes they can manage on their own, or replace the traditional laces with the curly "pull laces".
- Scarves, belts
- All food, drinks, and snacks
- Topical medications (sunscreen, chapstick, diaper cream, lotion, etc) need to be labeled with your child's name and given to a teacher. Due to safety concerns, they cannot be kept in your child's bag/pocket.

Outdoor Policy and Gear/Clothes Info

Chances are, you enrolled your child at this school in part because of our extended outdoor time. In order to be faithful to this, we are outside most of the day, in all kinds of weather, year round. Having the right gear and being able to put it on and take it off is a must. Some kids "run warm," some kids "run cold", and pretty much all of them run around the yard all day which keeps their blood pumping! The most important things to consider when choosing gear is keeping them DRY and giving them layering options. Talk with them about their different layers and when it may be a good time to take off the long sleeved shirt, pull on those mittens, or switch from rain boots to sneakers. Look at your weather app before leaving the house, look at the sky, and teach your child how to prepare well for their day. Bring their clothes and gear home when the seasons change and remove anything that is too small or not a good choice for the upcoming weather. Restock it with "yes" options for the current season and check the lost and found for things that belong to your child. It is your responsibility to make sure your child has the appropriate gear to safely and comfortably work and play outdoors for several hours. Out of respect to all the other children and families who come prepared, we are not able to stay inside because one family forgot their gear, and we may ask you to provide it before your child can stay and participate.

Clothes: Anticipate that your child may get dirty, painty, marked, glued, or otherwise messy while at school. We choose washable art supplies and encourage children to be responsible with their play, but sending them to school in clothes they should "try to keep clean" is probably not going to end well and will likely hinder their work. Hair should be pulled back out of faces and their clothes should be;

- Comfortable
- Easy to crawl, run, dance, and climb in
- Easy to put on and take off independently- for those over 18 months please avoid snaps, buttons, buckles and tight cuffs
- Clearly labeled with their name or initials

Shoes & Socks: While at school, your child will run, climb and walk on a variety of surfaces. It's a good idea to keep one extra pair of shoes at school. Most kids wear sneakers or enclosed

sandals throughout the summer/fall/spring. We want children to be as independent as possible with shoes so avoid tie laces and buckles. They will also need boots for the fall/winter/spring; plastic rain boots and snow boots can work, but insulated rain boots seem to be a great multi-season option. Three to five pairs of “back up” socks should be plenty, wool-blend socks stay much drier and warmer than cotton. When the weather is warm, we allow children to choose to wear their shoes or take them off.

Suggestions:

6mth-18 months: It’s so tricky to find shoes that stay on little feet but also allow for movement. Boggs toddler boots are our favorite (soft shell for the youngest, hardshell for the steady walkers) Booties for young ones who aren’t walking are important for dry days to keep dust/dirt/pokes off their fat little feet (harts stay on well)

18 months and up: Keen sandals, Natives, or most styles of velcro shoes are great. Crocs can work as long as your child can run and climb comfortably in them. Bogg boots, or most things from Jan and Jul, REI, Columbia works great.

Outerwear: Layers are super important for children to learn to manage their temperature. Make sure to keep some type of medium/light outer layer at school. Examples are a hoodie sweatshirt, a flannel, a cardigan, a fleece, etc. If your child runs cold, a pair of sweats or leg warmers are nice in the cooler months and on chilly summer mornings. If they sunburn easily, a UV protective rash guard and sun hat are great for the hot days.

Sprouts: Fleece onesies are great for winter, especially for children who “run cold”

Rain Gear: Lots of outdoor gear is *water resistant*, which will not hold up for a full day in the rain. Double check that everything is labeled waterproof, weatherproof, or rainproof. You can either choose a one piece rainsuit, or pair pants with a coat. It’s a good idea to have some back up rain gear if it’s going to pour during the day. It can be miserable to put a damp cold jacket back on after rest time.

Rainsuits: [tuffo/muddy buddy](#): Some families really like the rain suits since it covers most of their clothes and it’s just one thing to keep track of, plus they can basically go swimming and only their feet will get wet. This seems like the best option for the really little folks (under 2.5) since they typically are still falling down often and are still fairly reliant on a teacher to help gear them up and make gear choices for them. We’ve found the suits to be a bit awkward for the older children to put on and zip up themselves and tend to make kids too warm in the spring/fall and make it tricky to wear a coat in the winter. That said, a few of our preschoolers do have rain suits that work very well for them.

Two piece rain gear: On the bottom they’ll need a good pair of rain pants which will not only protect them from rain, but also dewy slides, damp grass, muddy knees, and chilly air. If they run cold, snow pants or puffer pants are a great choice in the colder months. On the top a thin waterproof jacket that can be worn over a warm thick hoodie/sweater will easily allow them to adjust their layers. Fleece and wool sweaters are a great choice for colder months. This combo

keeps them dry but not too warm year round. Those that run warm can opt for just their thin waterproof shell, but have the sweater handy if they get chilly. If they run cold or when the temperature is really low, then a warm waterproof winter jacket is a better choice. Double check the labels as many winter coats are not waterproof, and a wet puffer is heavy and cold.

Sprouts: The one piece suits are by far the easiest way to keep your child dry and their clothes kind of clean, especially if they are crawling/toddling with lots of tips and plops still. However, once they are actively toilet learning, we need to switch to a 2 piece set because there is just not enough time to take everything off!

Head/Hands: When it's warm and sunny it may be a good idea to send your child with a UV protection hat, especially if they burn easily. When it's cold, a wool/fleece hat or headband-style-ear-warmer is ideal. For their hands, mittens are way easier to put on and actually keep their hands warmer. Gloves can be tricky for the younger kids to put on by themselves, but do tend to be worn longer because of the increased dexterity. Either way, it's important to teach them to put their mittens/gloves in their pockets when not being worn, or invest in some glove clips.

Sprouts: Feel free to bring hats, we will absolutely try to keep them on your child. For hands- there just isn't a great solution. On the "too cold to be without" days, we highly recommend mittens (with or without thumb holes) that have a velcro strip at the wrist which we can tighten.

Where to buy: The Columbia brand tends to be a crowd favorite for light weight, reasonably priced gear that works great and lasts forever (buying it second/third hand is perfect!), they also have an outlet store in Woodburn and lots of sales online. Oakiwear and Jan and Jul make great kid stuff too, cuter color choices and patterns, sometimes wears out faster, but it'll easily last until they grow out of it. LL Bean, REI and other "outdoor/sport" stores often have reasonable options as well. Double check your buy nothing groups, friends who have bigger kids, and things like craigslist/fb marketplace. Super Kids Resale is where I regularly buy gear for my kids, and clearly they're rolling around in the play yard more often than most. Of course, there are always the options of old navy, target, and miscellaneous amazon brands, which will likely hold up for a season but maybe not any longer. It's also a great idea to trade/sell gear with other WPP families and we are working on creating a space for this to happen onsite.

Tuition and Fees

Enrollment for the school year begins with a \$500 deposit that holds your child's slot until September. At that point for new students, \$300 will go towards their annual enrollment fee and

\$200 will be credited to September tuition. Returning families will only pay a \$200 annual enrollment fee and so \$300 will be credited to their September tuition.

Tuition payment for the month is due on the 1st day of that month. Payments not made in full by 5:30pm on the 5th of the month will accrue a \$25 late fee. Returned checks will accrue a \$25 late fee. If the account is not paid in full by the 10th of the month the child may not return to care until the account is brought current. Accounts remaining unpaid beyond the 10th of the month may be grounds to terminate the contract.

You can pay us using all forms of checks, money orders, or using Zelle (find us listed under our email address, if it pops up as "Wild Primrose" that's us too!). We do not accept cash. Checks need to have your child's name written on them somewhere and can be mailed or dropped into the black box just inside the screen door of 9433. All payments must be received during business hours. Payments made after business hours will not be processed until the next business day, which may cause payments to be late and accrue late fees.

The first two weeks of care are a trial period, during which time either party may terminate without advanced notice. After the trial period, any modifications families would like to make to their contract, including termination will require a written notice thirty days in advance. Any family giving a 30 day notice will still be required to pay for that 30 days, regardless of attendance.

Children are not allowed to be dropped off before 7:30am. Children are required to be picked up before 5:30pm. Late pick ups will acquire an additional \$1 fee for every minute the child is left in care past 5:30pm. The time will be determined by our clock. Repetitive late pick ups may be grounds for termination.

Find a friend! If you refer a family to our program and they decide to enroll their child, you will receive a \$50 credit to your account during their second month of enrollment.

WPP Trading Days Policy

We know that families cannot always attend on their scheduled days, and other times they may need childcare on a day they aren't currently scheduled for. In order to help families get the care they need we have partnered with one of our skilled preschooler parents, Daniel Ray, to develop the day trader app. Once you set up your account you can freely buy/sell/trade days with other families in our community. Here are a few tips to keep in mind as you navigate the process:

1. When you buy/sell days using the day trader app, the transaction happens entirely between families and WPP isn't directly involved. We consider the day to be owned by the family who paid us tuition for it until either A) we get a notification from the app that says the day has been

paid for by another family, or B) we get a text/email from the selling family telling us that another family bought/traded for a day. A child may only attend care if they currently own the day, so please take care not to bring your child on a day you have sold to another family.

2. It is up to the “selling family” to clearly state what they are selling, the price/trade they are asking for, and how they want to be paid.

3. It’s up to the “buying family” to be sure they want what is being sold and to both indicate they want the day and make the payment directly to the selling family.

4. Once the day is paid for, it’s the responsibility of the selling family to either mark “verified payment” on the app and it will notify us, or if not using the app they need to send us and email/text that says “my child will not be there on this date, this family has their day!”

5. Once we hear from the app/selling family, then we change it on our attendance and the buying family now owns the day and that child is who we’ll accept into care that day.

6. It is not likely that we will approve a Preschooler to buy the day from a Sprouts child or visa versa. However, you are more than welcome to try and we will definitely assess if it makes reasonable sense to make an exception.

Waitlist

Families wishing to enroll their child at Wild Pear Preschool can be placed on the waitlist if there isn’t an immediate opening. In order to be waitlisted, families need to submit a completed application form and a non-refundable \$20 fee. Being placed on the waitlist does not guarantee enrollment at a later date. It does, however, guarantee that the child will have priority to enroll in any open slots as they become available.

When a slot becomes available, we will consider which family on the waitlist would be the best fit, with a goal to create well balanced cohorts of children while striving to coordinate each family’s preferred schedule. For this reason, we do ask that parents give us as much information as possible on their waitlist form and notify us of any changes that come up.

Once offered a slot, families will need to make a choice to either enroll or pass. If they choose to pass, they will remain on the waitlist and the slot will be offered to another family. In most cases families will have up to one week to decide if they want the available slot. If they do, they will need to pay the \$500 non-refundable deposit which will hold their slot for up to 3 weeks. \$300 of the deposit will cover the annual enrollment fee, while \$200 will be applied to the first month’s tuition.

Priority is given to currently enrolled families, as such, a current family looking to change their slot or enroll a sibling will be given first consideration and is not required to pay the \$20 fee.

Health Policy

Wild Pear's health policy is required to be in compliance with the Oregon Health Department and the Early Learning Department. This means that we can care for mildly ill children, however, there will be times when you cannot bring your child to school due to illness or will need to pick them up immediately if they develop symptoms while in care. If you are unable to pick up your child you will need to arrange for someone on their emergency contact list to come get them.

We understand it is difficult to find alternate care for sick children and we thank you in advance for making the arrangements to keep your sick children out of school so we can help our community stay healthy. It's likely that teachers who are repeatedly exposed to sick children will become sick themselves, and while the exclusion policy for teachers is less restrictive than for children (as they are able to mask, wash hands, and monitor their symptoms effectively) teachers will not be allowed to work with fevers, vomiting, or an inability to manage their symptoms. If many teachers need to be out, we may need to close.

Wild Pear Health Policy		
Children cannot be at school with:	While they're out:	They can return when:
Fever (100.4°F)	<u>Take a covid test.</u> Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any additional test results you may receive.	Fever free for a full <u>24 hours</u> without the aid of medication, and negative covid test results shared on the app messenger
Diarrhea (Two or more watery, bloody or loose stools in 24 hours, the sudden onset of loose stools, or a child unable to control bowel function when previously able)	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	Diarrhea resolved for a full <u>48 hours</u> , or with doctor's note
Vomiting	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	No vomiting for a full <u>48 hours</u> , or with a doctor's note

Severe or persistent coughing, difficulty breathing, abnormal wheezing	<u>Take a covid test.</u> Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any additional test results you may receive.	Symptoms have been improving for a full <u>24 hours</u> , (or with a doctor's note) and negative covid test results shared on the app messenger
Runny, drippy, sneezy or stuffy nose that is not manageable with reasonable age appropriate support from a teacher	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	Symptoms have been improving for a full <u>24 hours</u> , or with a doctor's note
Open sores or wounds discharging bodily fluids	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	Sores/wounds are healed, dry, or can be completely covered with a bandage, or with a doctor's note
Pink, weepy, pussy or excessively crusty eyes	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	Symptoms are resolved or with a doctor's note
A new rash, or unusual yellow color to skin or eyes	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any test results you may receive.	Symptoms are resolved or with a doctor's note
Extreme fatigue, persistent complaints of pain including headache and sore throat, or inability to participate in regular school activities	<u>Take a covid test.</u> Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out sick and give a brief list of their symptoms. Please also share any additional test results you may receive.	Symptoms are resolved (or with a doctor's note) and negative covid test results shared on the app messenger
Head lice or nits	Use the app messenger to let us know your child will be out with head lice	Nits and eggs no longer present

COVID Plan

While we are no longer operating as Emergency Childcare as we were during the COVID pandemic, we recognize that COVID will likely continue to be a threat to our community and we will protect ourselves in the following ways:

- All staff will be up to date on their COVID-19 vaccination
- All eligible children will be up to date on their COVID-19 vaccination
- We will maintain diligent handwashing, environmental sanitation, and extended amounts of time outdoors and fresh air circulation indoors.
- We will continue to exclude children who exhibit symptoms of COVID or who have been exposed to COVID in a way that is in compliance with Oregon Health Authority and Child Care Division rules.
- We will comply with all governmental and authority guidance on operations and will end program activities if cases or risk level warrant.
- The procedure for determining action when a child is exposed to, or tests positive for COVID is outlined in our illness and COVID policy.

Illness and Injury Policy

While health and safety is a priority at Wild Pear Preschool, it is still likely that your child will obtain small cuts and scrapes, bumps or bruises while in our care. Here is our protocol to care for minor injury and illness:

Illness:

- Upset stomach; encourage children to try and use the bathroom, drink water, eat a few crackers, rest
- Headache; encourage children to drink water, rest
- Stuffy/runny nose; encourage children to blow/wipe nose often
- Sore throat/cough; encourage children to drink water
- Children developing a fever, vomiting, diarrhea, a new rash and/or pink/goosey eyes while in care will be isolated from the other children and parents will be notified to come pick up their child right away. The same is true if we discover lice/nits.

Injuries:

- Small open wound, cut, or scrape; wash with soap and water, bactine and a bandage.
- Small bump, bruise or red mark; cold washcloth, ice pack.
- Minor burn; cold running water, ice pack.
- Sliver/splinter: child can attempt to remove with tweezers/tape, wash with soap and water, bactine and a bandage.
- Blister; cover with a bandage, wash with soap and apply bactine if it ruptures.
- Pain with no noticeable mark; cold/warm washcloth, icepack

If the injury/illness gets more serious, the child complains of increasing discomfort, or if they are unable to participate in our daily activities you will be called and asked to pick them up. We will use the app to send you information on any minor injury/incident your child experiences at school. You will get a message that says "incident report" and then you'll need to locate the

incident report on their feed. Typically, you will also see a photo of your child just above the report as well. Any serious illness, injury, or incident will be communicated with a phone call.

Immunization

We do require all students to be up to date on their required immunizations unless they have a medical waiver. Here is a link for [Oregon Child Care Vaccination Rates](#). You can find our program's vaccination rates by searching for "Wild Pear Preschool" or "Wild Primrose Preschool" for 2019-2020 and earlier. You can also view the [Child Care Immunization rates by County](#) here.

Medication Policy

Prescription RESCUE Medication

- Prescription medication must be brought to the program in its original container and include the child's name, the name of the medication, the dosage, the number of times per day and the number of days the medication is to be administered. This prescription label will be accepted as the written authorization of the physician.
- The program will not administer any medication contrary to the directions on the label unless authorized by written order of the child's physician.
- The parent must fill out the Authorization for Medication Form before the medication can be administered.

Prescription Non-Rescue Medication

Our program does not administer this type of medication. Parents are welcome to come administer the medication to the child on site.

Non-prescription Medication

Our program does not administer this type of medication. Parents are welcome to come administer the medication to the child on site.

Topical Ointments and Sprays

Throughout the year a few topical medications will likely need to be applied to your child including sunscreen, lotion, diaper cream and antiseptic. Due to the high frequency of use and the inability to predict when they will need to be used, we ask for you to sign a blanket permission slip for the application of these topical medications that will be effective for one year unless otherwise revoked in writing.

Sunscreen : During "sunburn season" we ask that your child come to school with sunscreen already applied. We will reapply sunscreen after nap time anytime the temperature is above 70. We will notify you of the specific sunscreen before it is used.

Lotion : Throughout the year children often get dry skin due to frequent hand washing and dry weather and it's great to offer their hands some comfort. We will notify parents of the specific brand upon request.

Antiseptic : For small cuts and scrapes we will have children wash the area with soap and water. After that we will apply a spray of "Bactine" (Active ingredients; Benzalkonium and Lidocaine). This is the only medication we will be applying to cuts and scrapes.

Diaper Cream: We will have both Desitin and Aquaphor available.

Chapstick: If you feel that your child needs to use chapstick at school, please write their name on it and give it to an educator. We will keep it in the first aid kit and provide access to it throughout the day, either at planned intervals or upon child request.

All Medications

- All medications must be given to a teacher/director directly by a legal guardian.
 - All medications will be stored out of the reach of children. All medications that are considered controlled substances must be locked and kept out of reach of children.
 - The teacher/director will be responsible for the administration of medication.
 - The program will maintain a written record of the administration of any medication (excluding topical ointments and sprays) which will include the child's name, the time and date of each administration, the dose, and the name of the person administering the medication. This completed record will become part of the child's file.
- All unused medication will be returned to the parent if possible, or disposed of in accordance with Department of Public Health guidelines.

Toileting/Diapering Policy

At Wild Pear, we welcome children with all levels of mastery and constancy regarding toilet use. We practice Elimination Communication (EC). Human waste will be discussed as a normal everyday part of life and children will learn about elimination as a biological response to the many functions of our amazing bodies. We will also respect the complicated task of mastering the use of the toilet and will never respond with disgust or an attempt to shame or embarrass children who are still working towards consistent toilet use. We will use the actual names of body parts involved with elimination including penis, urethra, vulva, and anus.

Children at all levels of independence will be encouraged to participate and learn relevant skills during toileting. This includes removing their own clothes/diapers, cleaning their own bodies, dressing themselves and cleaning up any soiled items as they are able. Once children are able to walk we will transition them from lay down

changes to stand up changes. Children will receive clear instructions regarding holding toilet paper/wipes to properly clean themselves. Teachers will ensure children are clean after diapering until the child is 4 years old or sooner if the child has consistently shown they are able to clean themselves reliably. Teachers will only offer a “teacher wipe” after poop to children who use the toilet if they are not yet 3 years old and/or are in the initial stage of learning to use the toilet. By the time a child is 4 they will be expected to do most of their toileting/diapering on their own.

We will not coerce or bribe your child to use the bathroom at certain intervals. Instead, we will give them lots of information, encourage them to listen to their bodies, provide lots of invitations to use the bathroom, and point out the natural consequences of their choices (both desirable and undesirable). We understand that there may be times when you as a parent have strong preferences regarding your child’s toileting frequency or method (diaper vs toilet). While we understand and respect this, we are unable to enforce such preferences at school. You are more than welcome to encourage your child to toilet in the way you prefer, and we can remind them of your wish, but ultimately the choice will be theirs while they are at school.

If your child isn’t totally consistent in their ability to use the toilet, we ask that you send at least one additional change of clothes to school each day (totaling two or more). Though they may need more if they are in the initial stage of toilet learning.

We will provide diapers for any child who needs them along with wipes and diapering cream. Families will need to authorize the use of one or both of the diapering creams available. Sprouts families who want their child to use water wipes, instead of the Kirkland brand wipes will pay an additional \$40 annual fee.

We expect children 2 and older to understand why their diaper needs to be changed regularly and be willing to participate and allow changes to happen as needed. If your child absolutely refuses a diaper change we will contact you. Children refusing to change a wet diaper can remain at school as long as the diaper is not leaking. If your child refuses to change a diaper containing poop creating an unsanitary situation, you may need to come change their diaper or pick them up. Children who regularly have accidents and don’t inform a teacher may need to wear a diaper while at school.

Diapers must always be changed in the bathroom at school. We ask that any diapers you change at school be done in the same style we use when a teacher changes them (stand up or lay down). You can find instructions for the stand up method in the bathrooms as well as in the policy notebook

Rest Time Policy

Engaged learning can be exhausting, and a midday rest is the way we honor the hard work our bodies and brains do during the day. After lunch, each child is asked to spend time relaxing quietly on a cozy resting cot that is set up with a sheet, a blanket and perhaps a pillow of stuffie. During the beginning of the rest period a teacher may read aloud, sing or play an audio book. Then children will be given some time to rest independently, and sleep if they need to. Soft music will be played during this part of rest time, and teachers will maintain supervision while also moving in and out of the room- cleaning and preparing for the afternoon. Towards the end of the rest period, children who are awake will be invited to do some quiet work on their resting mat which might including reading books, writing in a journal, drawing, doing yoga, or working on a puzzle. Finally, children who are awake will be asked to clean up their resting materials and children who are asleep will be allowed to keep sleeping.

We will not coerce your child to fall asleep or attempt to wake them early. Instead, we will give them lots of information, encourage them to listen to their bodies, provide the opportunity to rest quietly, and point out the natural consequences of their choices (both desirable and undesirable). Our consistent message to children at rest time is “You do not *have* to sleep, listen to your body and do what’s best for you. You only need to lay quietly on your cot for a bit so that your friends can fall asleep if they need to. Soon it will be time to play again.” We understand that there may be times when you as a parent have strong preferences regarding your child’s daytime sleep, while we understand and respect this, we are unable to enforce such preferences at school. You are more than welcome to encourage your child to sleep or stay awake, and we can remind them of your wish, but ultimately the choice will be theirs.

We ask each family to bring a crib sheet and a small blanket for their child to rest with. A pillow and small “stuffie” are optional. We will send napping items home weekly to be washed and returned to school on Monday.

Children under 12 months old will be allowed to sleep wherever they are tired, and will be provided with a safe and secure sleeping space in accordance with the Oregon Safe Sleep Laws. Because of these laws, we are unable to swaddle infants or use blankets in their beds. You are welcome to send a wearable blanket that does not constrict their

arm movements. We are also unable to use a pacifier with a stuffed animal or other clips attached to it for sleep. Please send only a pacifier, without any attachments.

Meal Information

While at school, children are served breakfast, lunch and an afternoon snack. Children under 18 months will also often be served a morning snack. These meals are included with tuition and are an integrated part of our Food and Nutrition Curriculum. As per the USDA food program guidelines, each meal includes an age appropriate portion of various food groups.

The food is cooked onsite by the teachers/directors and seasonal, local, and organic food is prioritized as well as food grown onsite. Children are invited to participate in food preparation as often as possible. We eat "family style" and children assist in setting the table, serving themselves and clearing their place when they're finished eating. Meals are a social time, when teachers eat with children and everyone is encouraged to enjoy the food and time together.

During meals, children are all asked to join the group at the table and put some of each type of food on their plates. However, children always get to decide which foods they try and how much they eat. At each meal we learn about the foods being served, including the nutritional benefit of choosing to eat it. We always encourage children to listen to their bodies, especially when it comes to eating and feeling full. Everyone clears their own space after meals; composting uneaten food, stacking dirty dishes, cleaning up spills and washing their hands and faces.

Children in the Sprouts program will be offered solid food no sooner than 6 months of age. Between 6 and 12 months solid foods will only be offered in conjunction with parental permission, using a form that will be hung in the kitchen and updated regularly. Food offered to children under 12 months will be whole foods, and almost always what the other children are being served. We are thoughtful to offer only foods that can be safely chewed/gummed, and slice food into "french fry shape" to make it easier to grasp, bring to their mouth, and manipulate in their mouths without choking. We do not feed children baby purees or baby cereals.

We understand that there may be times when you as a parent have strong preferences regarding your child's food consumption, while we understand and respect this, we are unable to enforce such preferences at school. You are more than welcome to encourage your child to eat a certain amount or try food in a certain way, and we can remind them of your wish, but ultimately the choice will be theirs.

Dietary Restriction Policy

At WPP food is important to us, and serves as a regular aspect of our curriculum. We want each child to feel good about nourishing their bodies during our meal and snack times. We also want

families to feel good about what food is being offered to their child during the day and we will work together with families to make a plan for a child that has dietary restrictions due to allergies, medical conditions, or moral, cultural, or religious exemptions.

We are proud to participate in the USDA food program, which helps reimburse us for the cost of food we serve the children. As participants in this program we are required to follow their guidelines for meals that insure all children have access to a variety of healthy food in developmentally appropriate portions. We depend on this reimbursement to help subsidize the rising cost of high quality food we serve in our program.

USDA will fully reimburse us for any child who receives modified meals due to an allergic/medical restriction that is confirmed by a Doctor to be necessary. Families who request food substitutions for other reasons can work with WPP to figure out a detailed plan of which foods need to be substituted and who will be responsible for providing them.

Rules and Discipline Approach

At Wild Pear Preschool we have only four rules; Be Safe, Be Respectful, Be Kind, and Be Responsible. They may seem like big concepts for young children. Here are some examples we use to explain what each rule means.

Being safe means nobody's body is hurt, nobody's feelings are hurt.

Being respectful means helping everyone to feel important, taking care of materials.

Being kind means touching gently, speaking compassionately, and waiting patiently.

Being responsible means taking care of yourself, following directions.

While we will be clear to establish the rules and behavioral expectations with your child, they will always view you as the "number one boss." You can help provide them with security and confidence by reminding them of the rules during your morning commute and by modeling appropriate behaviors while you are here. When your child sees you washing your hands at arrival, speaking warmly to other children and helping to pick up materials before you leave, they will be more likely to act that way while you are gone too.

We believe that there is no such thing as a "bad kid" or even "bad behavior." Instead, we view all behaviors as attempts by the child to get their needs met. It's from this perspective that we are able to creatively partner with children to shift their behaviors towards actions and expressions that are safe, effective and appropriate for a school setting.

We will not ever use corporal punishment, verbal assault, shaming, guilt, coercing, threatening, or isolation in an attempt to change a child's behavior. We don't even see a need to use time out or bribes at school.

Instead, we make sure children develop a strong understanding of appropriate ways to express needs and feelings, and help them learn to be aware of the needs and feelings of others. We discuss the natural consequences to their chosen actions and help them develop plans to avoid unwanted reactions while reaching their desired outcomes. There are discussions and reminders daily about what kinds of behaviors are expected and appropriate for our school setting.

If a child is really struggling, we may invite them to process their feelings in a safe space, away from other children or particular activities, or perhaps very close to a teacher. When the child is ready and able, we will debrief what happened and make a plan to avoid it in the future.

If there is a conflict between children, teachers will be in very close proximity ready to offer support. Our goal will always be to allow children to fully express their feelings and needs to one another, and to collaborate in reaching a solution that works for them. We will also advocate for restorative justice, which at this level often means refraining from requiring children to apologize and instead encouraging children to ask some basic questions of one another:

1. Are you ok?
2. What do you need to feel better?
3. Did that fix it?

At Wild Pear we work hard to create safe and inclusive environments where children, families and staff are treated with dignity and respect. We recognize that being a human, especially a young one, comes with all kinds of feelings and needs, and our goal is to meet children where they are and support them gently through the ups and downs of experiencing life together. Unfortunately, due to programmatic and monetary restraints, we can't always meet the needs of every child, and we don't have the resources to provide one on one care or contained safe spaces for children to process and move through overwhelming feelings and severe dysregulation. In the case that a child's behavior is regularly unsafe and/or requires excessive amounts of 1:1 teacher attention, the child's behavior will be closely documented and their family will be asked to help to create sustainable solutions to support the child so they can remain enrolled. We also invite the ESD and other service professionals to support the child during school as needed. Unfortunately, if no sustainable solutions can be found and we cannot meet your child's needs, we may need to unenroll your child. If you are concerned about your child's specific mental, social, or emotional needs being met, please let us know right away as we will need to partner with you to create a plan of support for your child.

Family Communication

While we will be glad to see you at arrival and departure, your child will likely need our support and attention during this transition time, and we ask that all conversations happening in front of the child also include them.

Message using the app

This will always be the best way to communicate with your child's teachers during the day. While we highly value face to face communication, it's not always guaranteed that something mentioned to a teacher in the bustle of drop off will be remembered or passed on. This is where the app is so handy. It's helpful if you communicate planned absences/early pick-ups/appointments along with any information you think would be helpful for all the teachers to know about your child. It's also a great place to ask questions about your child's experiences and behaviors (Ex. Did Jude sleep at nap today? Or, what are the words to the song you sang at circle today- I'm hearing something about feet being on the ground?) This would also be a great place to check in to see how your child is doing after a rough drop off. Make sure to check your child's feed on the app for photo updates, incident reports and for children under 12 months, updates on sleep, diapering and milk/food. Thank you for understanding that our priority is to have teachers off their phones and engaged with your child. We know that it can be difficult to wait for a message response, and often teachers may need to wait until nap time to reply. So if you haven't heard back by 1:30, then definitely ask again, but thank you for being patient otherwise.

Texting/calling:

If there is something more urgent that needs to be communicated, please text Susan and Jeannie on a joint thread that includes all your child's guardians. We will do the same. Texting is great for you to communicate unexpected absences/late arrivals, discussing COVID exposures, or to get a quick slightly urgent question answered if you haven't had a response on the app. We will use texts to communicate unplanned school closures, administrative reminders/questions or information about illness/injury that isn't serious enough to warrant a phone call but may need more direct communication than an app message.

Email/meetings

To check in about enrollment or tuition matters, to share questions or concerns about policies/procedures or anyone's behaviors, or just to initiate a longer conversation- email is your best bet! We can also schedule face to face or zoom meetings to have longer, more personal conversations as well.

We will regularly send out emails, please make sure you read them as you will be responsible to know the information they contain. Some are packed to the max with important information and links. Others are just quick reminders. Either way, give them a glance so you know what's going on. We will try to use bold font to help draw you to the most important parts, so if you're in a rush, scan for the bold.

Photo Sharing

While your child is at school we will regularly be taking photos of them for a variety of reasons. It might be to document the learning that is happening, to show families and/or the wider community what is happening at Wild Pear, or to use on our website. We will share photos of

your child and their peers with you on the app and also occasionally through a google photo album.

If you have concerns about your child's photo being shared outside of the "currently enrolled WP community" please let us know. We also ask that all families be respectful by asking parent permission or cropping out other faces before sharing or posting photos that include other people's children.

Policy Notebook

The policy notebook has a hard copy of this family handbook, a copy of the state licensing rules, reports from our various licensing visits, lead test results, food handler cards, and some other miscellaneous and detailed policies we are required to give you access to but didn't feel were critical to include in the handbook. This book is always available for you to view, and lives on the parent counter.

Family Involvement

We've said it before and we'll say it again- your family is the number one source of education for your child! The better partnered we are, the more consistent your child's learning and growth can be.

Family Activities

Each school year we have a handful of events and activities that we invite you to be a part of!

Family Conferences: These two conferences provide valuable time for parents to connect with teachers and share information regarding growth and goals of individual children. We started conducting conferences via zoom during 2020 and we really liked the flexibility the platform provided us with and have decided to keep it that way!

Volunteer Days: Families are often invited to come help us keep our environment in tip-top play condition. Tasks may include cleaning, yard work, book/toy repair, organizing materials, etc.

Family Events: All family events are free and fun for the whole family, siblings too! While you are not required to attend, we'd love for you to join us and spend time with our learning community. For the pumpkin patch trip we close early and each family drives their own child (or carpools!) and we meet up at the patch for an evening of fun. The parent's night out is exactly that- you leave your children with us for the evening and go have fun while we do activities, eat pizza, and watch a short movie. Spring fling is a social time for us to gather and celebrate the changing seasons. Our campfire night is a special ceremony to mark the end of the school year. The camping trip is a particularly favored event, come for a night or two or just visit for the day!

Birthdays at Wild Pear Preschool

We want to honor and celebrate each child's birthday, and so at Wild Pear we invite the birthday child to be the center focus of our special 15-20 minute "birthday circle". We will begin the circle by showing a photo of the birthday child when they were a newborn baby, and reflecting on how small, new, and dependent they were. Then the child will carry a globe for one trip around "the sun" while we sing a song:

The Earth goes round the sun
The Earth goes round the sun
Another year is done, is done
The Earth goes round the sun
(Tune of Farmer in the Dell)

Then we will show a photo of the child at age 1, and talk about how they changed, the new skills they mastered, etc. And again, they will walk around the sun while we sing. Next will be a photo and discussion of the child at age two, etc. When we reach the child's current age we will reflect on the many exciting things that might be in store for them in this new year of life and offer predictions and advice, cheers and claps as we welcome them into their new age.

Family is welcome, but not required, to attend the birthday circle if they are available at that time. We will make sure and take lots of pictures to share either way. On the day of your child's birthday circle, please send a picture of them as a newborn, one around their first birthday, one around their second birthday, etc. Photos can be digital or printed.

Plan for Meeting Potential Emergencies

This document lays out the plan of action should a disaster/emergency happen during Wild Pear hours of operation. We will be alert to emergency warnings, and will follow instructions of law enforcement and other designated authorities. We will use our training along with our best judgment to assess the situation and make the choices needed to keep ourselves and the children in our care safe and healthy until they can be reunited with their parents.

In the event of any disaster/emergency, we will immediately attend to the needs and well being of the children in our care, gathering them together in a safe space, visually checking attendance, and then keeping the children contained and engaged in a safe

space doing appropriate activities until the situation is resolved. The situation will be explained to children with a calm tone and age appropriate language.

As soon as the children are safe and gathered, an all staff text will be sent out and emergency services will be contacted. Second we will call and text all custodial parents. If phones are not working we will send emails and post updates on facebook (in lieu of providing an out of area phone number). Our attendance records and emergency forms are located in the sign in book and/or the first aid backpack. They will be gathered and kept with us during an emergency. We will use the nearest hospital that is available to us which is Providence Milwaukie Hospital (10150 SE 32nd Ave, Milwaukie, OR 97222 Phone: (503) 513-8300.)

In the event of a lost or missing child

As soon as an adult suspects a lost or missing child, all children will be gathered and kept together until the situation is resolved. Teachers will do a role call to get an accurate account of who is present. If it's discovered that a child is lost or missing, a teacher will immediately text all staff and anyone not counting in ratio will begin looking for the child on campus, beginning in the area the child was last known to be, and directors will look at the ring cams. If the child is still not found within 10 minutes, we will notify emergency services and a director will contact parents before beginning looking off campus.

In the event of a power, water, heat, or internet outage

In the event of a sudden outage of critical services we will look for notifications of what caused the issue and when it's suspected to be restored. If no information comes or the restoration time will be beyond the scope of our ability to provide safe and sanitary care, we will notify parents immediately and ask them to come pick up their children.

In the event of a medical emergency:

A medical emergency is an event where one or more children need urgent medical care from a hospital.

We will first contact emergency services, perform first aid/CPR on the child having the emergency and ensure the safety of the other children in care. As soon as we are able we will call the child's parents and notify them of the emergency. We will ensure that either a teacher or a parent remain with the child at all times, including if the child needs to be transported to the hospital. The other teacher will remain with the group of children, keeping them safe and calm.

In the event of a shelter in place emergency:

These are events that make it safer to remain sheltered inside than to be outside or evacuate and may include severe storms, dangerous person threat, chemical/radiation exposure, power outage, and earthquakes.

All parents will be notified. Teachers will remain with students on site until they are picked up by a parent or authorized adult. Teachers will have access to attendance records, emergency paperwork, rescue medication, a first aid kit, and an emergency kit that includes food and water, temporary toilet, child activities, and other emergency supplies. We will shelter in place in the main classroom, unless it is safer to be in an alternate space.

In the event of an evacuation:

These are events that make it safer to leave the main school building and may include flood, fire, gas leak, dangerous person threat, chemical/radiation exposure, and earthquakes.

All parents will be notified. We will bring the first aid kit, attendance records, and emergency kit with us. At Sprouts, if the evacuation is short term, the entire group will move out to the far back covered area in the school age yard. Preschoolers will move down to the lower yard tent. We will remain there until it is safe to re-enter the building and/or the children are picked up by their parents. If the evacuation is long term, we will post a note on the door explaining where we have evacuated to. Ideally, we will move next door to the other site, but if this is not a safe option we will walk to the Milwaukie City Planning Building (6101 SE Johnson Creek Blvd, Portland, OR 97206) or the Wichita Center (6031 SE King Rd, Milwaukie, OR 97222).

In the event of an earthquake:

We will drop and take cover until the shaking stops and it is safe to move. We will then follow the evacuation procedure.

In the event of a lock down:

This is an escalated dangerous person threat whereby we believe the children are in direct danger.

All parents will be notified. One teacher will move all children into the school hallway, turn off the lights, and close the doors. The other teacher will lock all the doors and get the first aid kit, attendance, and emergency kit before joining the group. If needed, the entire group will move into the back bedroom. We will then follow the shelter in place procedure. If the adult is in the house, one adult will attempt to delay or distract the intruder while the other adult moves the children into the bathroom and locks the door.

In the event of a teacher down:

This is an event where a teacher is incapacitated due to sudden injury or illness and needs urgent medical attention.

If there is a second teacher present, she will call for backup, instruct the children to move to a different space and do an activity (go to the other side of the room and look at books) and will then follow protocol for a medical emergency. In order to prepare for a situation where there is not a second adult present, we will teach the children to stay near the teacher and yell loudly, "We need help!" and to blow the whistle on the backpack.

Weather emergencies:

This includes extreme temperatures (above 100°F or below 20°F with windchill and humidity factored in) or air quality

We will limit time outside and closely monitor conditions and child/adult health during "yellow conditions" as per the [Child Care Weather Watch Chart](#). During cold weather emergencies where conditions move into the red zone, we will bring children inside where they will remain for the duration of the emergency. During a hot weather emergency, we will assess the safety of the inside conditions (as we do not have air conditioning) and close if we are unable to provide a safe respite from the heat. If the AQ is 150-200 (red) we will be open for a half day only (7:30-12:45), with pick up being directly after lunch. If the AQ is above 200 (purple or maroon) we will be closed.

Certificates and Affiliations

Jeanise Suihkonen:

Associates Degree in Early Education
Master Trainer for OCCD
Infant and Child First Aid and CPR
Food Handlers License

Susan Nasiombe:

Bachelor's Degree in Elementary Education
Master's Degree in Education, Leadership and Management (focus on Social Justice Education)
Infant and Child First Aid and CPR
Food Handlers License

Wild Pear Preschool

Certified by the Oregon Department of Early Education
City of Milwaukie Business License
Clackamas County Health Inspected
USDA Food Program
DHS approved Provider
Oregon Family Child Care Network (OFCCN)
Professional Resource Organization (PRO)
Oregon Association for the Education of Young Children (OAEYC)

Mandated Reporting

All teachers and directors are legally required to report concerns of child abuse and neglect.

Report complaint

We are licensed as a Certified Family Child Care and we abide by the applicable Oregon State Rules and Regulations. We have a copy of the rules on hand if you'd like to review it. You can also find them online via a link to the Oregon Early Learning Website on the Resource page of our website.

If you have a question, complaint or a problem we would love to have a discussion with you. If you do not feel comfortable with that and feel that it is serious, you may make an official complaint to the Office of Child Care's Central Office at 1-800-556-6616. You will speak to a compliance specialist who will take your information and refer it to a local child care licensing specialist to follow up on. You may also check our program's complaint and compliance history by following a link listed in the resource page of our website.